AI Agent Build Section

A Practical Guide for Technical & Non-Technical Builders
Visual, beginner-friendly, step-by-step guide, but still technically accurate.

This guide uses **two live builds** from the workshop:

1. **Email Draft Response Agent** (Beginner)
2. **Business Idea Generator Agent** (Intermediate)

What an AI Agent Actually Is (Simple Definition)

An AI agent is a system that:

- Watches for inputs (triggers)
- Reasons about them using AI
- Produces useful outputs
- Sometimes takes actions on your behalf

Agents don't just respond — they operate.

The Core Agent Pattern (Learn This Once)

Every agent you build in Make follows this pattern:

```
Trigger
→Process Input
→AI Reasoning
→Process / Decide
→Output
```

Overall pattern this pattern for every agent you ever build.

DEMO 1: Email Draft Response Agent (Beginner)

Pattern: AI as Assistant

This agent is **reactive**. It helps you in the moment.

What this agent does

- Triggers on an email
- AI drafts a clear, professional response

No automation complexity. No background logic.

When this pattern is useful

- Writing emails
- Responding fast
- Speeding up admin work

Flow overview

```
Manual Trigger
→ AI Draft Response
→ Output
```

Step-by-step

1. Trigger - Watch Emails

- Use Watch Emails (Microsoft Outlook/Gmail
- Watch Emails: Enter which email you want to view
- Mail Folder: Select the folder you want to view
- Limit: Set to however many emails you want to view

2. Tools - Set Multiple Variables

- Item 1 Variable Name: Email Sender. Variable Value: Sender.Email Address
- Item 2 Variable Name: Email_Subject. Variable Value: Subject
- Item 3 Variable Name: Email_Body. Variable Value: Body

3. AI Reasoning [Make AI Agent]

System Instruction

```
You are a professional assistant.
```

User prompt

```
Draft a clear, polite, and professional reply to the email below.
Keep the response concise and realistic.

Email:
{{1*.Email_Sender}}{{1*.Email_Subject}}{{1*.Email_Body}}
```

3. Output Microsoft 365 Email Outlook

- Send via email to Microsoft 365 Outlook Recipients : Email Address - Your own email address.Subject : Email Draft

- Body Contenmpate style="white-space: pre-wrap; font-family: ui-monospace, SFMono-Regular, Menlo, Monaco, Consolas, 'Liberation Mono', 'Courier New', monospace;">
- 1{{aiagent}}
- </pre>

Teaching takeaway

> "This is AI responding on my behalf, not acting on its own."

This is an **assistant**, not a full agent yet.

DEMO 2: Business Idea Generator Agent (Intermediate)

Pattern: AI as Agent / System
This agent exists **to play** even when you're offline.

What this agent does

- Monitors RSS feeds
- Analyzes content
- Generates business ideas
- Stores results in Google Sheets

This is a **proto-AI agent**

Why this qualifies as an agent

- External input (RSS)
- Decision-making (which ideas)
- Reasoning not pattern-matching
- Runs automatically
- Produces consumable insight

Flow overview

```
RSS Trigger
→ AI Reasoning (JSON)
→Parse JSON
→Iterator
→Text Aggregator
→Sheets Export
```

Step-by-step

1. Trigger [External signal]

- Use **Watch RSS feed items**(RSS + https://medium.com/feed/tag/entrepreneurship or use you can use any your own RSS Feed items

2. Prepare Input

[Optional]

- Use a **Text Aggregator** to combine article titles or summaries(Source Module: RSS - Watch Feed Items Text Article Title Title Article URL 1:URL

3. AI Reasoning [Make AI Agent]Model - Medium GPT OSS 120 GB

System Prompt

```
You are a startup analyst.
From the content provided - {{2.text}}
Generate 1 concrete business idea.
Each idea must include:
1 one-line idea
- The problem it solves
- Who it is for
Return ONLY valid JSON in this format:
{
  "ideas": [
    {
      "idea": "",
      "problem": "",
      "audience": ""
    }
  ]
}
```

4. Parse JSON [Structure the intelligence]

Create a data structure:

- Name : Ideas
- Type: Array
- Source: Specification - Collection
- Name: Title
- Type: Text
- Name: Problem
- Type: Text
- Name: Audience
- Type:Text

- JSON String
- Make AI Agent Response

```
{{ai.ai2.*}}{{idx. problem. audience
```

Strict Mode: OFF
This tells Make how to understand the AI output.

5. Iterator [Split ideas]

- Array: {{ai.ai2}}
Iterates split bundles.

6. Text Aggregator [Create report]

- Source Module: **Iterator**

```
Idea: {{item.idea}}
Problem:
{{problem}}
Audience:
{{audience}}
---------------------
```

Text Aggregators recombine bundles.

7. Email Output

- Send **one email**
- Body = Text Aggregator output

```
Subject: 🚀 Business Ideas {{formatDate(now; "YYYY-MM-DD")}}
Body Content:
<pre style="white-space: pre-wrap; font-family: ui-monospace, SFMono-Regular, Menlo, Monaco, Consolas, 'Liberation Mono', 'Courier New', monospace;">
Here are this week's business ideas inspired by recent articles:
{{2.text}}
</pre>
```

Demo 3 : Career Helper AI Agent [Intermediate]

1) Trigger / Input

Use either:

- **Tools** → **Set variable** or **Tools** → **Manual trigger**

Create variables:

- user_input = {{my payload.*}}, job desc, email, etc
- prompt = {{system1 "Response":"data", "Analyze":"job"}}

2) Router Agent [The Manager Brain]

Add:

- **Make AI Agents** → **Run an Agent** (or OpenAI Chat Completion if you prefer)

Prompt for Router Agent:

```
You are a classifier.
Decide what kind of career request this is.

Possible categories:
- CV
- COVER_LETTER
- CAREER_PROGRESS

Return ONLY one of these words.
No explanations. No punctuation.

User input:
user_input (earlier variable)

User goal:
goal (earlier variable)
```

This step should output ONLY:

- A CV
- or COVER_LETTER
- or CAREER_PROGRESS

3) Add Make Router (Green Router Node)

Add:

- **Flow Control** → **Router**

Create 3 **routes** with filters

Route 1: CV

Router output **equals** CV

Route 2: Cover Letter

Router output **equals** COVER_LETTER

Route 3: Career Progression

Router output **equals** CAREER_PROGRESS

4) CV Specialist Branch

If using RAG:

- Add **Notion / Docs / Data Store** → **Search**
- Then **Text Aggregator**
- Feed retrieved content in context

Add Agent: "CV Specialist"

- **Make AI Agents** → **Run an Agent**

Prompt:

```
You are a senior career coach.
Rewrite the following CV.

User CV:
user_input (your earlier variable)

Goal:
goal (your earlier variable)

Context:
- Emphasize weak bullet points
- Improve impact and clarity
- Add strong action verbs
- Highlight achievements

Output:
1. Improved profile summary
2. 3-4 improved bullet points
- Short list of key improvements
```

Then: Save to Notion

- **Notion** → **Create a Page**

- Title: CV Review - {{date}}
- Body: Agent output

5) Cover Letter Specialist Branch

Then:

- **Make AI Agents** → **Run an Agent**

Prompts

```
You are professional cover letter writer.
Write a tailored cover letter using the input below.
Context (optional reference material):
{{retrieved_docs}}

Input:
user_input (your earlier variable)

Goal:
goal (your earlier variable)

Rules:
- Max 300 words
- Professional but human
- Highlight 3 strengths
- End with a confident closing
```

Then: Save to Notion

- **Notion** → **Create a Page**

- Title: Cover Letter Draft - {{date}}
- Body: Agent output

6) Career Progression Specialist Branch

- **Make AI Agents** → **Run an Agent**

Prompts

```
You are a career strategist.
Based on the information below, create a career progression plan.

Input:
user_input(your earlier variable)

Tasks:
- Summarize current position
- Suggest next role(s)
- Identify skill gaps
- Create a 6-12 month action plan
```

Then: Save to Notion

- **Notion** → **Create a Page**

- Title: Career Plan - {{date}}
- Body: Agent output

Key Concepts Everyone Should Understand

Assistant vs Agent

- Assistant waits for someone you ask
- Agent runs continuously on a schedule

Iterator vs Aggregator

- Iterator = splits data
- Text Aggregator = combines outputs for reports

Why structure matters

- Prompt guides creative
- Structure prevents chaos

Final mental model [remember this]

> "Assistants help me. Agents work for me."

Once you understand this, you can build any agent in Make.

End of guide.